



Security Watch

Sour Cup Of Java

The Problem

Sun has reported a serious vulnerability in the Java Runtime Environment (JRE).

In the JRE, it's a buffer overflow vulnerability. This might allow a non-trusted applet or application to change system privileges. For example, an applet may grant itself permissions to read and write local files or execute local applications. A second vulnerability here may allow a non-trusted applet or application to cause the Java Virtual Machine to hang.

The Solution

Visit <http://tinyurl.com/2mnjae> for information on what you need to do for your OS.

QuickTime Woes

The Problem

Multiple critical vulnerabilities have been reported in Apple's QuickTime, wherein malicious people can compromise a user's system.

The Solution

Update your copy of Apple QuickTime—<http://tinyurl.com/2vwdxc> for Windows, and <http://tinyurl.com/35zvwv> for the Mac

competition (AMD is still in the picture). There will be collaboration. And we can hope for something concrete to result.

ERASE YOUR TRACES

Anonymous Surfing Goes Mainstream

As you know, search giant Google keeps a history of your searches after you log into Google accounts. The following might seem insignificant for those with the technical savvy and inclination to cover their online tracks if and when they need to—whether by way of cookies or by way of using the feature Google provides to manage search history—but the fact is, not everyone is savvy, and not everyone is inclined that way enough to bother—and really, not everyone has the time to bother.

In view of this, Web-search portal Ask.com thought of going against the norm set by Google. Ask recently introduced a tool

called AskEraser to its portal: AskEraser will allow users search anonymously and set a privacy level. If the user doesn't want any search history maintained, he or she can select the option of not retaining any such data whatsoever.

If AskEraser is not turned on, the machine IP address will be stored along with cookie information and the URL the visitor goes to. Ask will stop linking searches to IP addresses after a period of 18 months. However, a halt on data deletion will be ordered if the US government has to retain data for investigation.

Microsoft will join Ask.com on the same front, allowing their users to search anonymously on Windows Live Web sites. They, too, will scrub all search query data after 18 months, data that could identify the searcher. Google, too, recently announced it would make the data it stores about its users anonymous after 18 to 24 months. All this comes at a time when what terrorists and would-be terrorists are searching for has come under the scanner.

As a matter of fact,

HOT

Yahoo! Mail Beta

IM integrated with Web mail is almost the norm now. Google added the chat feature to Gmail in June 2006; users could have chat sessions and mail in the same window. In February 2007, Yahoo followed suit...



Hotmail

...But despite being the pioneers of Web mail, MSN Hotmail (now Windows Live Hotmail) still doesn't seem to get it. There might still be a lot of users of the once-Hot mail, but the others have a definitive edge now.



search engines retain user data for site improvement, which brings in the risk of data being hacked or misused. Pressure from the European Union on the time limit for retaining users' search query history has led to this situation. Microsoft and Ask.com are looking forward to invite Web portals like Google, AOL, and Yahoo!, as well as privacy advocates, for talks

Opinion Poll

(One Silly Question makes way for Opinion Poll. You, too, can participate at www.thinkdigit.com)

What security software do you have installed on your computer?

1 Everything, from anti-virus to anti-phishing software.

2 A firewall, an anti-virus, and anti-spyware and anti-malware.

3 Only an anti-virus.

4 Security software... what's that?

2



"I like to try out new software, so I have almost everything installed. The anti-phishing software I don't use because I do not do Internet banking or other such transactions on the computer."

Pommy Bal
Mumbai

1



"Definitely. I want to keep my computer clean and safe. I don't want it to stop working."

Santhosh S
Bangalore

2



"No anti-virus or anti-spyware product is perfect—for example, if Avast! detects a file as a virus or Trojan, Kaspersky finds the same file safe."

That's why I keep two types of anti-virus, anti-spyware, and firewall installed on my computer. I also like to check their working and performance—and how secure and safe they are on the PC."

Anurag Pandey
Delhi

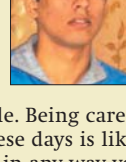
3



"I don't have the Internet on my PC at home, so I don't need anything apart from an anti-virus. I use Avast!, which I keep up-to-date using the updates you provide on your CD."

Priyobatra Sharma
Bangalore

1



"Today, a leak in your security could mean anything—losing your bank balance, theft of sensitive personal information—the consequences are unthinkable. Being careless with your security these days is like being ready to be looted in any way you can be."

Rohit Patel
Rajkot

4



"I use Linux full-time!"

Prakash J Kokkattu
Hyderabad